





Clockwise from extreme left: A view of The Golden Temple at the ambrosial hour; Embossed gold sheets depicting floral motifs and an image of Guru Gobind Singh; Devotees in the lavishly decorated corridor on the first floor; The Palki carrying the Guru Granth Sahib from the Golden Temple to the Akal Takht



shifting light and vantage. The photographs open into ritual and ceremony, into the fine grain of the shrine's craft—*Naqqashi* engravings, stone inlay, gold relief work, artefacts rarely seen, each drawn out by studied light. But the book's emotional centre lies elsewhere—in the faces and forms of the devotees lost in earnest prayer, in hands doing sewa at the langar's community kitchen.

The book's mammoth format lets these visuals breathe with the same spaciousness one feels approaching the shrine itself. To engage with this volume is to enter an immersive ritual, lifting its weight, turning its large pages, moving slowly through its visual narrative. It slows the eye that lingers on the page with contemplative awe.

Devotees know this feeling as *Darshan*.